signing of its official peace treaty with Israel in 1994, maintained extensive ties with Israel.

The so-called “third-party principle” in the relationship between Israel and its great ally, the United States, merits a brief discussion. During the period of the Cold War (1945–90), the limits of the intelligence cooperation between the United States and Israel were clear-cut. It was a bipolar world in which each of the two superpowers had a camp of allies. It was clear that the United States would not share intelligence with us about Saudi Arabia, or the Gulf States, or Egypt in the post–Yom Kippur War period, when Egypt became an important ally of the United States in the Middle East, and certainly not about Turkey, which was an official NATO member state and was considered a major American ally because of its proximity to the Soviet Union and its control over the straits leading from the Black Sea to the Mediterranean Sea and from it to the Atlantic Ocean and the Suez Canal.

The British foreign intelligence service (MI6), one of the oldest in the world, enjoys great prestige and esteem in the intelligence world. Unlike in most Western democracies, this agency reports to the foreign minister and not to the prime minister. This structure has always dictated complete symmetry between the principles of British foreign policy, including in the Middle East, and intelligence cooperation between Britain and other countries. It is therefore not difficult to understand that British foreign policy, which prioritized its relations with the Arab states over its relations with Israel, also directly affected the intelligence ties between the two countries. Things changed for the better with the end of the Cold War and the collapse of the Soviet Union, when Britain and Israel found themselves facing more and more common threats, in particular radical Islamic terrorism and the proliferation of nonconventional weapons. This will be expanded upon below.

The end of the Cold War era in 1990 was an important milestone for the Israeli intelligence community as a whole, and for the Mossad, whose role has an international character, in particular. Throughout the Cold War era, the intelligence community maintained a regional system that covered the Middle East and Europe. Here and there, according to unique and ad hoc needs, it spread its wings to cover other parts of the world but always made a point of returning to its home system.

The geostrategic changes that accompanied the end of the Cold War generated a sharp and relatively quick transition from a bipolar world to a